

2008ICT Design Thinking in IT Assessment T1 2026

Assignment 1: Design Document/Low Fidelity Prototype (40%)

Team: Report (single PDF document). Online submission EOD Friday Week 6

Individual: Peer Review (PDF). Online submission EOD Friday Week 6

Assignment 2: Website + Code (40%)

Team: Code (single .ZIP file). Online submission EOD Friday Week 12

Team: Pitch video (single MP4 file) Online submission EOD Friday Week 12

Team: Demonstration. In class (NA/GC) or Online (OL). **Week 12**

Individual: Peer Review (PDF). Online submission EOD Friday Week 6

Assignment 3: Journal/Reflective Report (20%)

Individual: One PDF document. Online submission EOD Friday Week 13

Objective

Design Thinking provides a basis for collecting, refining and communicating ideas into designs. Ultimately, these design needs to map to a deployable system. The assessment for this course involves a mini project that will be completed by teams of up to six (6) students. The students will apply the course material they have learnt in the course to produce not only a working website but also several support documents.

The topic for the project this year is: “**Help manage energy or water use in a household without the users feeling overwhelmed or confused.**” Defining and refining the exact problem statement and content to be focused on will be up to the project groups and will be part of the any requirements gathering needed for the project to support a design and the website implementation.

Assignment 1: Design Document/Low Fidelity Prototype (40%)

Team: Report (single PDF document). Online submission EOD Friday Week 6

Individual: Peer Review (PDF). Online submission EOD Friday Week 6

A design document will be produced capturing the requirements for the project and showcasing a low fidelity prototype. The documentation will be completed based on the lecture/seminar material concurrently with the practical web technology workshops. The focus will be the design of the front-end of the website.

You will be demonstrating your use of the Design Thinking methodology.

The design document and low fidelity prototype will be marked according to the Assignment 1 marking criteria, that is available on the course website. *Time spent on this assignment should be explicitly noted in the weekly diary upload and the final journal section (see Assignment 3 below).*

The Design Document should have the following sections:

1. Introduction - including team membership
2. Use of Design Thinking
3. Requirements
4. Storyboards
5. Universal Design/Branding

6. Low Fidelity Prototype – developed with approaches taught on this course
7. Meeting minutes and meeting summaries

This is a team-based assignment and only one report is required per team. An individual peer review form is **also** required from all students. An individual student's submission is not complete until the peer review document has been uploaded. Non-submission or late submission of peer review forms will only impact individual students. The report and peer review should be uploaded to the course website as a single PDF documents before the **EOD Friday Week 6**.

Assignment 2: Website + Code (40%)

Team: Website Demonstration. In class (NA/GC) or online (OL only). **Week 12**

Team: Website Code (single .ZIP file). Online submission **EOD Friday Week 12**

Individual: Peer Review (PDF). Online submission **EOD Friday Week 12**

Knowledge of web technologies is delivered in the course workshops. The design from Assignment 1 will be developed into a functioning website. This assessment will evaluate the final website and will be marked according to the Assignment 2 marking criteria, that is available on the course website.

Specifically, the use of the workshop material will be evaluated in terms of: the quality of the final website; that the application is complete; that the application provides the required functionality; that the website aligns with the design document; that it achieves the design goals through elements such as layout, functionality, interaction and navigation; that it adheres to good design thinking principles. Also code quality, including evidence of good coding practice, i.e. for app maintenance/updates/extensions etc. and clear and appropriate code documentation will be evaluated. *Time spent on this assignment should be explicitly noted in the project journal (see Assignment 3 below).*

The final version of the website will be demonstrated to course staff during **Week 12**. The schedule for the demonstrations will be made available later in the course. The website code will be uploaded to the course site as a single ZIP file by **EOD Friday Week 12**.

Team: Pitch video (single MP4 file) Online submission **EOD Friday Week 12**

Each team will also record and upload a 5 minute "pitch" video that includes:

- An overview of their design
- Examples from the final website
- Overview of security needs, now and in the future, for the website

Presentation marks will be awarded for quality and "style". You are free to use whatever technology you have to record the video. It could be a formal presentation in PowerPoint or a more casual face-to-face talk. The target audience for the pitch is a hypothetical company that might want to partner with you to implement your solution.

An individual peer review form is **also** required from **all** students. An individual student's submission is not complete until the peer review document has been uploaded. Non-submission or late submission of peer review forms will only impact individual students.

Assignment 3: Journal and Reflective Report (20%)

Individual: One PDF document. Online submission **EOD Friday Week 13**

The Journal and Reflective Report has two sections. One on the Journal and one on Reflections.

For the journal section, you will collect your weekly diary entries and combine them to document the time and associated activities you have undertaken on this course. As a general "rule" for a 10-unit course, you should spend

10-12 hours per week on the course activities. Some of this is organized for you (1 hour lecture, 2 hour workshop, 1 hour common time) and you *might* spend 1 hour preparing for the workshop and 1 hour pre/post the lecture looking at the material. As there is no exam to prepare for, this leaves at least 4 hours per week on the assignments.

Each week you will submit online a diary entry on the previous weeks work. This will be reviewed but no feedback provided. Project questions should be directed to the Common time sessions. The diary entries will contribute to Assessment 3 and an ongoing holistic review of your progress, combined with evidence of class engagement, peer reviews and completion of course tasks. An academic judgement on this will determine a weighting factor across all team assessment (see the marking criteria document). Diary entries will log activities completed that week:

For Assessment 3, students will combine these entries as a **Journal section**, to **document use of time** on the course and **provide evidence of engagement** with the course material. There is no set format for the journal but it is suggested that you use a Word document (or similar) and log entries as:

Week:	Time spent:	Activity/Event:
Examples		

The “Examples” may a text paragraph describing and/or reflecting on an activity, or screenshots/photos of draft prototypes that didn’t make the grade or some other elements of iterative development or website progress. All slt is important that **you start collecting this information from week 1** as **all assessment on this course** will use the journal as a reference point for individual course engagement.

In the Reflection section, you will reflect on the use of Design Thinking in IT, the evaluations you contributed to in week 8 (and/or other sessions), on the team elements of the course project.

The journal and reflective report will be marked according to the Assignment 3 marking criteria, that is available on the course website.

The Journal/Reflective Report should have the following sections:

1. **Journal Entries**
 - a. Entry logs across [Week, Time spent, Activity/Event, Examples] – see above.
 - b. Each week may have single or multiple entries, depending on the tasks undertaken that week.
2. **Reflective Report**
 - a. Reflection on Design Thinking (1-2 pages)
 - b. Reflection on User Evaluation (0.5-1 page)
 - c. Reflection on Team (0.5-1 page)

Project Teams

You will complete the project in teams of six (6) students. Teams will be allocated during the first workshop.

Week 8 Low Fidelity Prototype evaluation session

During the seminar/lecture session in week 8, you will present your low fidelity prototype to other teams to explore your design decisions and gather feedback. This will involve either a heuristic evaluation or a cognitive walkthrough (as discussed in the Week 7 content).

You should have the following prepared for this session.

- Your low fidelity prototype should be ready. This may be from the material submitted in Week 6 and/or components of your current version of your website.
- A briefing that you plan to give to the evaluators. Refer to the ethical concerns section on the following page².
- The tasks/elements/scenarios of your application that you want feedback on.
- An observation sheet to record feedback.

You may only present your prototype to other students studying 2008ICT this year. This is cross campus so you can engage with teams from Nathan, Gold Coast or Online. The 1-hour session in Week 8 is one opportunity to present your prototype. You can arrange for other sessions (and log these in your diary). **Assignments will have significant marks deducted if prototypes are presented to people outside the 2008ICT cohort.**

Your team should be prepared to run the heuristic evaluation/cognitive walkthrough of your prototype with only 2-3 students from your team (one managing the presentation and others taking notes & asking questions for clarifications). This will free up the other members of your team to participate in other teams' evaluations.

During the 1-hour session, there should be time to present your prototype at least twice, so you will need to practice and make sure you have the timing correct for the scenarios you want feedback on. Each team will provide an evaluator to another team twice. Thus, all team members should be clear on the roles needed to present and evaluate their prototype. Each team should aim to have a minimum of two tests conducted.

The testing will be marked as part of the "Reflection on User Evaluation" in the **Reflective section** of the final report. You should ensure that you note the team you were the evaluator for so that your reflection can be cross-referenced with that team's project. Reflections that cannot be cross-referenced with another team's prototype may attract significantly lower marks.

Academic Integrity

Plagiarism is an attempt to gain credit for something that is not your property, not your idea or not your work, by pretending that work produced by others is your own. Any plagiarism will be dealt with under the rules applying under the university handbook as described in the course outline. For more information see your course profile (requires you to be logged in) and the academic integrity website: <https://www.griffith.edu.au/academic-integrity>

Use of Generative AI

Use of generative AI is discouraged and is not needed for this course. If any generative AI technologies are used, you must ensure you have acknowledged this - listing the name, version, model, and source of the generative AI technology. Material that is overly general and/or lacks the appropriate context will attract significantly lower marks.

Ethical Concerns in Working with Test Users

Serving as a test user can be very distressing, and you have definite responsibilities to protect the people you work with from distress. We have heard of test users who left the test in tears, and of a person in a psychological study of problem solving who was taken away in an ambulance under sedation because of not being able to solve what appeared to be simple logic puzzles. There's no joke here.

Another issue, which you also must take seriously, is embarrassment. Someone might well feel bad if a video of them fumbling with your system were shown to someone who knew them, or even if just numerical measures of a less-than-stellar performance were linked with their name.

The first line of defence against these kinds of problems is voluntary, **informed consent**. This means you avoid any pressure to participate in your test, and you make sure people are fully informed about what you are going to do if they do participate. You also make clear to test users that they are free to stop participating at any time, and you avoid putting any pressure on them to continue, even though it may be a big pain for you if they quit. You don't ask them for a reason: if they want to stop, you stop.

Be very careful about getting friends, co-workers, or (especially) subordinates to participate in tests. Will these people really feel free to decline, if they want to? If such people are genuinely eager to participate, fine, but don't press the matter if they hesitate even (or especially) if they give no reason.

During the test, monitor the attitude of your test users carefully. You will have stressed that it is your system, not the users, that is being tested, but they may still get upset with themselves if things don't go well. Watch for any sign of this, remind them that they aren't the focus of the test, and stop the test if they continue to be distressed. We are opposed to any deception in test procedures, but we make an exception in this case: an "equipment failure" is a good excuse to end a test without the test user feeling that it is his or her reaction that is to blame.

Plan carefully how you are going to deal with privacy issues. **The best approach is to avoid collecting information that could be used to identify someone.** We make it a practice not to include users' faces in videos we make, for example, and we don't record users' names with their data (just assign user numbers and use those for identification). If you will collect material that could be identified, such as an audio recording of comments in the test user's voice, explain clearly up front if there are any conditions in which anyone but you will have access to this material. Let the user tell you if he or she has any objection, and abide by what they say.

A final note: taking these matters seriously may be more than a matter of doing the right thing for you. If you are working in an organization that receives research funds you are obligated to comply with formal rules and regulations that govern the conduct of tests, including getting approval from a review committee for any study that involves human participants.

From: Task Centered User Interface Design, Lewis and Rieman (2008)